

NOVALITY STORE

Hamish

the Highland Cow

Amigurumi Crochet Pattern — worked in pieces, sewn with confidence

INTERMEDIATE | US TERMS | SIZE 14-15 CM | CODE NS01

Corrected Edition • PDF pattern — this is not a finished toy

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Meet Hamish



A shaggy, sturdy Highland cow with a flattened brow, a wide cream muzzle and a weather-beaten fringe. Hamish is worked in pieces — head, body, ears, horns, legs, muzzle and belly patch — so every proportion can be pinned and checked before sewing. The optional crochet scarf (or a ribbon) finishes his weather-beaten look.

At a glance

Skill level	Intermediate — comfortable with spiral amigurumi, invisible decreases and sewing pieces
Finished size	Approx. 14–15 cm (5.5–6 in) seated at stated gauge — confirm on your sample
Gauge	11 sc × 12 rnds = 5 cm (2 in) in spiral single crochet
Hook	3.5 mm (US E-4) — smaller than the ball band so stuffing cannot show
Terminology	US crochet terms throughout
Time	Approx. 6–8 hours

Safety — read first.
Hamish uses two 12 mm plastic safety eyes. Lock each washer firmly from inside the head **before** stuffing and joining, then check the eye and fabric by hand. Sew every seam twice, weave ends in at least 5 cm, and secure every knot in the fringe and tail. If an eye, washer or stitch fails, a small part can be released: not suitable for children under 3. Embroidered eyes remove the plastic-eye hazard but do not by themselves make a toy compliant — sellers must meet the toy-safety rules of their market.

How this pattern is written

- Work in a **continuous spiral** unless told otherwise; use a stitch marker in the first stitch of each round.
- The number in brackets at the end of each round, e.g. (48), is the **stitch count** — count often, especially after increase and decrease rounds.
- **Stuff as you go** where instructed; the head and body are joined through their matched 24-stitch openings.
- Rounds are written top-down for the head and bottom-up for the body — follow the section headings.

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Materials & Tools

Item	Details
Yarn A — Ginger	Worsted / aran (#4), approx. 35 g including fringe. Caramel, toffee or ginger gold.
Yarn B — Oat cream	Worsted / aran (#4), approx. 12 g — muzzle, horns, inner ears, optional belly patch.
Yarn C — Dark chocolate	Worsted / aran (#4), approx. 5 g — hooves and nostril embroidery.
Yarn D — Rust (optional)	Worsted / aran (#4), approx. 6 g for the scarf — or a generous 40 cm ribbon, fitted on the finished cow.
Hook	3.5 mm (US E-4)
Eyes	Two 12 mm black safety eyes — or black embroidery floss for an embroidered-eye version.
Notions	Polyester fiberfill (approx. 35 g), stitch marker, tapestry needle, pins, scissors.

Yarn notes

- Quantities are for the yarns and gauge above. If you substitute yarn, weigh your first finished piece before estimating yarn for more cows.
- Keep tension firm: at the correct gauge, stuffing should never show through the fabric.
- Check your gauge on a small spiral swatch (Rounds 1–6 of the head) before you begin: 11 sc × 12 rnds = 5 cm.

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR	magic ring	inc	2 sc in the same stitch
ch	chain	dec	invisible decrease (front loops of next 2 sts together)
sl st	slip stitch	BLO	back loop only
sc	single crochet	FO	fasten off
hdc	half double crochet	st(s)	stitch(es)

Before you start.
Read the Assembly section (page 6) once through so you know which openings stay unclosed: the head and body both finish at **24 stitches**, and the legs keep their top openings for sewing.

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Pattern

1 Head — Yarn A (top-down, continuous spiral)

R1 6 sc in MR **(6)**

R2 inc in each st around **(12)**

R3 [sc, inc] × 6 **(18)**

R4 [2 sc, inc] × 6 **(24)**

R5 [3 sc, inc] × 6 **(30)**

R6 [4 sc, inc] × 6 **(36)**

R7 [5 sc, inc] × 6 **(42)**

R8 [6 sc, inc] × 6 **(48)**

R9–R15 sc in each st around (7 rnds) **(48)**

*Insert the 12 mm safety eyes between **R10 and R11**, 7 stitches apart centre-to-centre. Reach inside and lock the washers firmly.*

R16 [6 sc, dec] × 6 **(42)**

R17 [5 sc, dec] × 6 **(36)**

R18 [4 sc, dec] × 6 **(30)**

R19 [3 sc, dec] × 6 **(24)**

Stuff the head firmly. FO after R19 with a 45 cm sewing tail. **Leave the 24-stitch neck opening unclosed.**

2 Muzzle — Yarn B

R1 6 sc in MR **(6)**

R2 inc in each st around **(12)**

R3 [sc, inc] × 6 **(18)**

R4 [2 sc, inc] × 6 **(24)**

R5–R6 sc in each st around (2 rnds) **(24)**

R7 [2 sc, dec] × 6 **(18)**

FO with a 35 cm tail. With Yarn C, embroider two diagonal nostrils on the upper front and secure the tails inside. Lightly stuff, flatten into a wide horizontal oval, and sew centred below the eyes over **Head R13–R16**, following the curve of the head.

3 Body — Yarn A (bottom-up, continuous spiral)

R1 6 sc in MR **(6)**

R2 inc in each st around **(12)**

R3 [sc, inc] × 6 **(18)**

R4 [2 sc, inc] × 6 **(24)**

R5 [3 sc, inc] × 6 **(30)**

R6 [4 sc, inc] × 6 **(36)**

R7 [5 sc, inc] × 6 **(42)**

R8 [6 sc, inc] × 6 **(48)**

R9 BLO sc in each st around — flat sitting base edge **(48)**

R10–R16 sc in each st around (7 rnds) **(48)**

R17 [6 sc, dec] × 6 **(42)**

R18 sc in each st around **(42)**

R19 [5 sc, dec] × 6 **(36)**

R20 [4 sc, dec] × 6 **(30)**

R21 [3 sc, dec] × 6 **(24)**

Stuff firmly, packing the flat base so Hamish sits level. FO with a 45 cm tail; **leave the 24-stitch neck open**.

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4 Belly Patch — Yarn B (optional)

Ch 6.

R1 sc in 2nd ch from hook, 3 sc, 3 sc in last ch; along opposite side of chain: 3 sc, 2 sc in first working ch **(12)**

R2 inc, 3 sc, inc × 3, 3 sc, inc × 2 **(18)**

R3 sc, inc, 3 sc, [sc, inc] × 3, 3 sc, [sc, inc] × 2, sl st to first sc **(24)**

FO with a 30 cm tail. Sew vertically, long axis upright, to the centre front of the body over **R10–R17**, stopping at the first decrease round.

5 Legs — start Yarn C, change to Yarn A

Choose **Option A** — four splayed Standard Legs — or **Option B** — upright sit: 2 Standard Legs (back) + 2 Shortened Front Legs.

Standard Legs (make 4 for Option A; 2 for Option B backs)

R1 (C) 6 sc in MR **(6)**

R2 inc in each st around **(12)**

R3 [sc, inc] × 6 **(18)**

R4 BLO sc in each st around — flat hoof sole **(18)**

R5 sc in each st around **(18)**

R6 sc in each st around; change to **Yarn A** on the last pull-through **(18)**

R7 (A) BLO sc in each st around — colour-transition ridge **(18)**

R8 [sc, dec] × 6 **(12)** — stuff the hoof firmly

R9–R13 sc in each st around (5 rnds) **(12)**

R14 [2 sc, dec] × 3 **(9)** — stuff the upper leg lightly

R15–R16 sc in each st around (2 rnds) **(9)**

FO with a 35 cm sewing tail; leave the 9-stitch top open.

Shortened Front Legs (Option B only, make 2): work R1–R8 of the Standard Leg, then R9–R10 sc in each st around (12). Stuff the hoof firmly and the top lightly. FO with a 35 cm tail; leave the 12-stitch top open.

6 Flat Layered Ears — 2 Outer (Yarn A) + 2 Inner (Yarn B)

R1 6 sc in MR **(6)**

R2 inc in each st around **(12)**

R3 [sc, inc] × 6 **(18)**

Inner ear (B): FO and weave in ends. **Outer ear (A):** do not FO. Mark the first stitch of each layer; place inner and outer **wrong sides together** (cream facing front), markers aligned, and work **18 sc in Yarn A** through corresponding stitches of both layers around the perimeter. FO with a 30 cm tail. Pinch 3 bottom stitches together and tack closed to cup the ear; sew to **Head R8–R10**, behind and outside the eyes.

7 Horns — Yarn B (make 2)

R1 4 sc in MR **(4)**

R2 [sc, inc] × 2 **(6)**

R3–R4 sc in each st around (2 rnds) **(6)**

R5 [2 sc, inc] × 2 **(8)**

R6–R7 sc in each st around (2 rnds) **(8)**

FO with a 30 cm tail. Stuff the tip lightly. For a gentle upward curve, pinch R4 to R5 on the inner side with one tiny hidden stitch. Sew all 8 base stitches to **Head R6–R8**, just above and forward of the ears.

8 Tail & Fringe — Yarn A

Tail: cut 6 strands of Yarn A, 22 cm each. Attach with lark's-head knots into 2 adjacent stitches at the centre back on **Body R10**. Braid the 12 hanging ends for 4 cm, tie an overhand knot, and trim the tassel to 1.5 cm.

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Fringe: cut 36–40 strands of Yarn A, 14 cm each. After the horns and ears are sewn on, attach strands with lark's-head knots in a horseshoe across the forehead on **Head R6, R7 and R8**, between the horns and ears. Trim into a neat V just above the muzzle.

9 Scarf — Yarn D (optional)

Ch 92.

Row 1 hdc in 3rd ch from hook and in each ch across; ch 2 (does not count), turn **(90)**

Row 2 hdc in each st across; FO and weave in ends **(90)**

Try the scarf on the finished cow and add rows for a longer drape if you wish — or tie on a 40 cm ribbon instead.

Assembly

1. **Head to body.** Align the 24 open stitches of Head R19 with the 24 open stitches of Body R21, face centred forward. Whipstitch through all 24 matched pairs **twice** — head tail for one pass, body tail for the second — topping up neck stuffing before the final 3 pairs.
2. **Front legs.** Pin over Body R9–R11 on the front chest, leaving 8 body stitches between their inner edges. Angle them forward so the hooves rest flat on the table; sew around the open rim twice, catching every rim stitch.
3. **Back legs.** Pin over Body R9–R11 on the rear flanks, angled outward so the hooves project past the front legs. Sew around the rim twice. Sit Hamish down and check he stands level before final tightening.
4. **Order check.** Horns, ears and fringe go on the head; muzzle below the eyes; belly patch (if used) centred on the front of the body; tail at the centre back.

Finishing checklist

- Every seam sewn **twice**; all ends woven in at least 5 cm and trimmed.
- Safety-eye washers locked and checked by hand (skip if embroidered).
- Fringe and tail knots secure; fringe trimmed clear of the eyes.
- Hamish sits level, face centred, hooves flat.
- Surface clean: gently brush the fringe with your fingers to separate the strands.

Care

Spot-clean with a damp cloth and reshape while drying. If washing is unavoidable, hand-wash cool, press water out in a towel, reshape and dry flat. Re-check all seams and eyes after washing.

Thank you for making Hamish!
This is the **Corrected Edition (v2)** of design NS01: stitch counts, component openings and placements have been re-audited. Finished-item photos may be shared with credit to **Novality Store**. This PDF is for personal use — please do not copy, share or resell the file. You may sell finished cows made from this pattern in small batches, crediting "Pattern by Novality Store".

Found an error or stuck on a round? Note the section and round number and contact the shop — corrections are issued as free updates to this file.

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